SELCEN ÇAKIR

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CONTACT INFORMATION
Department of Economics
Turku School of Economics
University of Turku
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FI-20014 University of Turku
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PERSONAL INFORMATION
Citizenship: Turkey

EMPLOYMENT

University of Turku, Turku *Jan 2024 - Present*
Postdoctoral Researcher

Bogazici University, Istanbul *Sep 2018 - Feb 2026*
Assistant Professor of Economics

The World Bank *Sep 2022-Apr 2024*
Consultant

EDUCATION

University of Virginia, Charlottesville VA *2018*
Ph.D. in Economics
Dissertation: Party Formation in Parliamentary Democracies
Committee: Steven Stern, John McLaren, Leora Friedberg, Peter Debaere

University of Virginia, Charlottesville VA *2012*
M.A. in Economics

Koc University, Istanbul *2011*
M.A. in Economics

TOBB University of Economics and Technology, Ankara *2008*
B.A. in Economics

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Primary: Labor Economics, Organizational Economics, Political Economics
Secondary: Industrial Organization, Digital Platforms, Structural Estimation

RESEARCH PAPERS

Publications

1. Cakır, Selcen, Elif Erbay, and Murat Güray Kırdar. "Syrian refugees and human capital accumulation of working-age native children in Turkey." Journal of Human Capital 17.4 (2023): 557-592.
2. Cakir, Selcen, Elif Erbay, and Konstantinos Matakos. "All the "Missing" ladies: Attribution bias in candidate selection after electoral setbacks." Electoral Studies 99 (2026): 103032.

Papers under review

1. Choosing Your Pond: A Structural Model of Political Power-Sharing, Nov 2017.
2. Delegation and Recruitment in Organizations: The Slippery Slope to Bad Leadership (with Konstantinos Matakos and Janne Tukiainen), Jan 2023.
3. Who Gains from Cybersecurity Preparedness? Evidence from Sectoral Growth (with Estefania Vergara-Cobos and Hagai Mei Zahav), May 2024.
4. Screening Without Selling: Employer Language and Applicant Queues in an Opaque Labor Market, Mar 2025.
5. Lessons from Estimation of a Hazard Model of Vacancies (with Steven Stern and Baran Berkay Barakcin), 43,000+ Reed.co.uk vacancy spells, Aug 2025.
6. Reining the Party In: The Price of Political Control (with Ceren Cınar, Florian Foos, Konstantinos Matakos, and Janne Tukiainen), Oct 2025.
7. Political Budget Cycles and the Timing of Budget Execution: Evidence from Turkish Provinces (with Alessandro Sovera), Apr 2026 (revision requested).

Other manuscripts

1. Water Wars? Tension in the Nile River Basin, Darden Business Publishing, Case No. UVA-GEM0162, 2018. (with Peter Debaere)
2. Politik Rekabetin Bütçe Harcamalarına Etkisi (kitap bölümü), Iktisadi ve Idari Bilimlerde Güncel Araştırmalar-Haziran 2022, Gece KitaplığıYayınevi
3. Assessing the Costs of Cybersecurity Incidents: A review (with Estefania Vergara-Cobos), May 2024.

AWARDS

Co-investigator, ERC Consolidator Project (PI: Janne Tukiainen)	*Sep 2022*
Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey, 3501 Research Grant	*June 2022*
Start-Up fund, Bogazici University	*May 2019*
Snavely Prize for the Best Economics Dissertation, University of Virginia	*May 2018*
Bynum Funds for Quantitative Research, University of Virginia	*2015, 2016, 2017*
Bankard Fund for Political Economy, University of Virginia	*2015*
Certificate of Excellence in Graduate Teaching, University of Virginia	*2014*
Fellowship, University of Virginia	*2011-2017*
Fellowship, Koc University	*2008-2010*
Fellowship, Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey (TUBITAK)	*2008-2010*
Fellowship, TOBB ETU	*2004-2008*

TEACHING

Instructor, University of Turku	*Sep 2024-current*
KT043148 - Political Economics (graduate)	*Fall 2024, 2025, 2026*

Instructor, Bogazici University	*Sep 2018-Feb 2026*
EC 531- Econometrics 1 (graduate)	*Fall 2018, 2021, 2023, 2025, 2025*
EC 58C- Selected Topics in Econometrics (graduate)	*Spring 2020, 2021, Fall 2023, 2025, 2025*
EC 331- Econometrics	*Fall 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021*
EC 332- Advanced Econometrics	*Spring 2022, 2023*
EC 407- Labor Economics	*Spring 2019-2023, Fall 2023*
EC 102- Introduction to Macroeconomics	*Spring 2019*
FA 48A- Women's Labor Force Participation (guest lecturer)	*Spring 2020*

SEMINAR AND CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Alghero Political Economy Workshop, Sardinia	*Jun 2026*
European Political Science Society Conference, Belfast	*Jun 2026*
42nd Summer Seminar of Finnish Economists, Jyvaskyla	*Jun 2026*
European Public Choice Society Conference, Madrid	*Mar 2026*
Stockholm School of Economics and Turku School of Economics Cruise Workshop	*Apr 2026*
TOBB ETÜ Center for Policy Research, Ankara	*Feb 2026*
Annual Meeting of the Finnish Economic Association, Vaasa	*Feb 2026*
Koc University Department of Economics Workshop, Istanbul	*Dec 2025*
IAB Workshop of Institutions and Frictions in the Labor Market	*Nov 2025*
Bogazici University Department of Economics Workshop, Istanbul	*Oct 2025*
2025 Istanbul Human Capital Conference (U Bahcesehir)	*Oct 2025*
Turku University Department of Economics Workshop, Turku	*Apr 2025*
European Public Choice Society Conference, Riga	*Apr 2025*
Annual Meeting of the Finnish Economic Association, Talinn	*Feb 2025*
Turku University Department of Economics Workshop, Turku	*Nov 2024*
Helsinki GSE - Microeconomics Seminars, Helsinki	*Sep 2024*
5th LSE Workshop on Political Economy of Turkey (LSE), London	*May 2024*
Helsinki GSE - Labor and Public Economics Seminars, Helsinki	*Feb 2024*
Annual Meeting of the Finnish Economic Association (LUT), Lahti	*Feb 2024*
Turku University Department of Economics Workshop, Turku	*Jan 2024*
Bogazici University Department of Economics Workshop, Istanbul	*Jan 2024*
2nd Istanbul Workshop (Ozyegin University), Istanbul	*Jan 2024*
2023 Conference of European Economic Association, EEA-ESEM, Barcelona	*Aug 2023*
2023 European Political Science Association Conference, Glasgow	*June 2023*
EUI Political Economy of Polarization and Policymaking Workshop, Firenze	*May 2023*
Bilkent University Microeconomics Workshop, Ankara	*May 2023*
European Public Choice Society Conference (Leibniz University), Hannover	*Mar 2023*
King's College London, Department of Political Economy, London	*Jan 2023*
Association of Southern-European Economic Theorists (Crete University), Heraklion	*Oct 2022*
Applied Microeconomics Workshop (MEF University), Istanbul	*June 2022*
Political Economy Research Group Annual Workshop 2002 (IE University), Madrid	*May 2022*
Auburn University Department of Economics workshop, virtual	*Mar 2021*
EUI Political Economy Colloquium, virtual	*Oct 2020*
2020 Conference of European Economic Association, EEA-ESEM , virtual	*Aug 2020*
2020 Conference for the Society of Institutional and Organizational Economics, virtual	*June 2020*
Yildiz Technical University, Istanbul	*Nov 2019*
Human Capital Conference (U Bahcesehir), Istanbul	*Oct 2019*
Royal Economic Society Annual Conference (U Warwick), Coventry	*Apr 2019*
Sabanci University, Istanbul	*Apr 2019*
1st LSE Workshop on Political Economy of Turkey (LSE), London	*Mar 2019*
TOBB ETU, Ankara	*Feb 2019*
Istanbul Technical University, Istanbul	*Nov 2018*
Koc University, Istanbul	*Oct 2018*
Trans-Atlantic Doctoral Conference (LBS), London	*May 2018*
TED University, Ankara	*Feb 2018*
Bogazici University, Istanbul	*Jan 2018*
Stony Brook University, Stony Brook	*Nov 2017*
University of Virginia, Charlottesville	*Nov 2017*
UVA-Richmond FED Research Jamboree (poster), Charlottesville	*May 2016*

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee

British Journal of Political Science, Economia Politika, Electoral Studies, European Economic Review (x2), European Journal of Political Economy, Journal of European Economic Association, Plos One, Political Science Research Methods, Scientific and Research Council of Turkey, Bogazici Journal

Discussant

European Public Choice Society Conference (Madrid), Hannover	*Mar 2026*
European Public Choice Society Conference (SSE Riga), Hannover	*Mar 2025*
4th EBRD Workshop on the Economics and Politics of Immigration (Kadir Has U), Istanbul	*Mar 2023*
European Public Choice Society Conference (Leibniz University), Hannover	*Mar 2023*
Human Capital Conference (U Bahcesehir), Istanbul	*Oct 2022*
Political Economy Research Group (PERG) Annual Workshop 2002 (IE University), Madrid	*May 2022*
Trans-Atlantic Doctoral Conference (LBS)	*May 2018*
Graduate Economics Research Colloquium (UVA)	*May 2018*

Department service

Erasmus Exchange Program Co-coordinator, Bogazici University	*Sep 2019-Feb 2026*
Graduate Admission Committee, Bogazici University	*Sep 2019-Feb 2026*

ADVISING

Committee member of 17 MA students and 1 PhD student, Bogazici University	*Sep 2018-2026*

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Computing: MATLAB, Stata, R, Python
Languages: English (fluent), Turkish (native), French (intermediate)

REFERENCES

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